meat, fish, fruits and vegetables. These foods get spoiled easily by natural enzymes.

8.2.4 Signs of Spoilage in Foods

The spoilage signs vary with the type of foods, causes of spoilage and environment.

Signs of spoilage: Spoilage generally seen are softening, hardening, discolouration, mould growth, fermentation, drying, oozing out of liquid, off odours such as mouldy, alcoholic or putrid and presence of insects.

The following gives the spoilage indicators in different categories of food:

1. ***Cereals and pulses:*** Although the foods do not spoil easily, the following signs could be noted if spoilt.
- Musty odour and off flavor.
- Presence of weevils, beetles, moths and worms.
- Clumping of whole grains.
- Presence of dirt, mud and stones.



▲ Plate 8.8 Spoiled Carrot

2. ***Vegetables and fruits:*** These show the following signs of spoilage:
- Presence of mould, leading to rot.
- Green leafy vegetables are wilted and limp.
- Discolouration and mushy texture.
- Presence of insects and worms.
- Green potatoes, sprouted potatoes and over mature vegetables.
- Skin or peel is damaged or bruised.



▲ Plate 8.9 Sprouted Potato

3. ***Milk and milk products:*** These products which get spoilt may show one or more of the following changes:
- Change in taste to sour or bitter.
- Milk, buttermilk or curds have a frothy, bubbly surface.
- Change in smell.
- Rope formation.



▲ Plate 8.10 Curdled Milk

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